

Nordic Warm Minimal

A design language for calm, human, and purposeful interfaces. Built on warmth, restraint, and the feeling that something is quietly alive.

01

Philosophy

Warm, not cold

Nordic minimalism but with cream and amber, not clinical white and grey. The space should feel like a Sunday morning, not a hospital.

Alive, not static

Everything breathes. Elements animate on a 4s cycle mimicking natural breath. Nothing is aggressive — like a candle, not a strobe.

One thing at a time

Screens are singular in focus. No competing CTAs, no dense dashboards. Generous negative space is not wasted space.

02

Color

Background

Surface
--color-
surface ·

Amber

Sage

Dust

--color-bg ·
#F4EDE4

#PDF8F0

--color-amber ·
#B8956A

--color-sage ·
#7B9E80

--color-dust ·
#C4806A

Text Dark

--color-text-dark ·
#2B2018

Text Muted

--color-text-muted ·
#9A8C85

Text Faint

--color-text-faint ·
#B0A49C

Semantic usage

Amber — primary actions, progress, emphasis, quotes

Sage — success states, positive confirmations, "I did it"

Dust — soft failure/missed states (never punishing, just honest)

Text Dark — headlines only

Text Muted — body copy, descriptions

Text Faint — captions, labels, metadata

03

Typography

Font stack

Cormorant Garamond Jost

--font-serif · weights 300, 400 --font-sans · weights 300, 400, 500

Display — Cormorant 300, 2.4rem

```
font-family: var(--font-serif); font-size: 2.4rem; font-weight: 300;
```

Heading — Cormorant 400, 1.7rem

```
font-family: var(--font-serif); font-size: 1.7rem; font-weight: 400;
```

Subheading — Cormorant 300, 1.2rem

```
font-family: var(--font-serif); font-size: 1.2rem; font-weight: 300;
```

Body — Jost 400, 0.87rem, line-height 1.75. Used for all descriptive text, instructions, and supporting copy. Always muted, never dark.

```
font-family: var(--font-sans); font-size: .87rem; color: var(--color-text-muted); line-
```

CAPTION / LABEL — JOST 500, 0.68REM, UPPERCASE, TRACKED

```
font-size: .68rem; letter-spacing: .16em; text-transform: uppercase; color: var(--color
```

"Motivational or reflective quotes, always italic serif in amber."

```
font-family: var(--font-serif); font-style: italic; font-size: 1rem; color: var(--color
```

breathe

scale 1 → 1.07 → 1,
4s ease-in-out ∞
Orbs, focal elements

breatheSoft

scale 1 → 1.015,
shadow shift, 4s ∞
Cards, containers

fadeUp

opacity 0→1,
translateY 18px→0,
0.55s
Screen transitions

glow

box-shadow pulse in amber, 4s ∞
Orbs (paired with breathe)

Rules

- All breathing animations share the same 4s duration so they feel like one organism
- Screen entries use `fadeUp` only — one animation per transition
- Hover states: `transform: scale(1.04)`, `transition: .2s` — never more
- Delays can be used to stagger sibling orbs (`animation-delay: 0s, 1s, 2s`)
- Never animate color, only scale, opacity, and shadow

```
@keyframes breathe {
  0%, 100% { transform: scale(1); }
  50%      { transform: scale(1.07); }
}

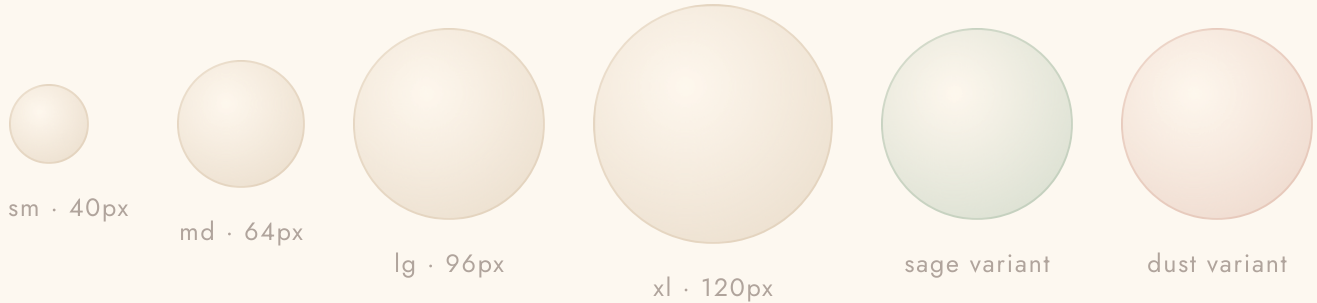
@keyframes breatheSoft {
  0%, 100% { transform: scale(1); box-shadow: 0 4px 30px rgba(60,40,20,0.06); }
  50%      { transform: scale(1.015); box-shadow: 0 8px 40px rgba(60,40,20,0.10); }
}

@keyframes fadeUp {
  from { opacity: 0; transform: translateY(18px); }
  to   { opacity: 1; transform: translateY(0); }
}

@keyframes glow {
  0%, 100% { box-shadow: 0 0 0 0 rgba(184,149,106,0.15); }
  50%      { box-shadow: 0 0 0 18px rgba(184,149,106,0); }
}
```

Component — Orb

The visual anchor of the system. Represents presence, focus, and life. Always breathing. Used as the emotional center of a screen.



```
/* Base orb */
.orb {
  border-radius: 50%;
  background: radial-gradient(circle at 38% 34%,
    rgba(255,248,238,0.85),
    rgba(184,149,106,0.28));
  border: 1px solid rgba(184,149,106,0.18);
  animation:
    breathe 4s ease-in-out infinite,
    glow 4s ease-in-out infinite;
}

/* Variants - swap rgba values only */
.orb-sage { background: radial-gradient(...rgba(123,158,128,0.3)); }
.orb-dust { background: radial-gradient(...rgba(196,128,106,0.28)); }
```

Component — Card

The content container. Breathes softly. Semi-transparent to let the background warmth show through.

Go outside for 5 minutes

Walk to the end of the street and back. No destination needed.

"You moved through the world today."

```
.card {  
  background: rgba(253,250,246,0.92);  
  border-radius: 24px;  
  padding: 2rem 1.8rem;  
  border: 1px solid rgba(220,210,198,0.65);  
  animation: breatheSoft 4s ease-in-out infinite;  
}  
  
/* Small variant */  
.card-sm {  
  padding: 1rem 1.25rem;  
  border-radius: 14px;  
}
```

07

Component — Buttons

BEGIN

Primary · Amber

I did it

Success · Sage

not today

Ghost · Dust

Rules

- Always pill-shaped (`border-radius: 50px`)
- Hover: `scale(1.04)` only — no color change on primary
- Letter-spacing on primary: `.13em` uppercase — makes short labels feel intentional
- Never more than 2 buttons on screen at once. Never 3.

```
.btn-primary {
  background: #B8956A; color: #FDF8F0;
  border-radius: 50px; padding: .85rem 2.4rem;
  font-family: var(--font-sans); font-size: .82rem;
  letter-spacing: .13em; text-transform: uppercase;
  transition: transform .2s, opacity .2s;
}
.btn-primary:hover { transform: scale(1.04); opacity: .88; }
```

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Component — Progress Dots

Quiet progress indicator. No numbers, no percentages. Just a sense of where you are.



step 3 of 10



step 7 of 10

```
/* Active dots: amber. Inactive: muted sand. */
.dot { width: 5px; height: 5px; border-radius: 50%; background: #DDD4C4; opacity: .45; }
.dot.active { background: #B8956A; opacity: 1; transition: background .4s, opacity .4s; }
```

09

Component — Range Slider



mood / intensity scale

```
input[type=range] {  
  -webkit-appearance: none;  
  width: 100%; height: 2px;  
  background: #DDD4C4; border-radius: 2px;  
}  
  
input[type=range]::-webkit-slider-thumb {  
  -webkit-appearance: none;  
  width: 22px; height: 22px; border-radius: 50%;  
  background: #B8956A;  
  box-shadow: 0 2px 10px rgba(184,149,106,0.45);  
  transition: transform .2s;  
}  
  
input[type=range]::-webkit-slider-thumb:hover { transform: scale(1.18); }
```

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Background System

The background is never just a color. Two soft radial gradients create ambient warmth — amber top-left, sage bottom-right. Fixed position so they don't scroll.

ambient background


```
/* Apply to root container, position: fixed, pointer-events: none */  
background:  
  radial-gradient(ellipse at 25% 20%, rgba(200,168,128,0.14) 0%, transparent 55%),  
  radial-gradient(ellipse at 75% 78%, rgba(122,158,126,0.09) 0%, transparent 45%),  
  #F4EDE4;
```

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Spacing & Layout

`--space-1`

4px · micro gaps

`--space-5`

24px · section rhythm

Max width

370px · mobile-first
single column

`--space-2`

8px · tight groups

`--space-6`

32px · card padding

`--radius-pill`

50px · buttons

`--space-3`

12px · label → value

`--space-7`

48px · section gap

`--radius-card`

24px · cards

`--space-4`

16px · component gap

`--space-8`

64px · page padding

`--radius-small`

14px · small surfaces

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Screen Anatomy

Every screen follows the same top-to-bottom rhythm. Vary the content, keep the structure.



② ORB — EMOTIONAL ANCHOR

③ OPTIONAL EYEBROW LABEL

Main heading

Supporting description — body text, muted.

④ CARD (IF NEEDED)

"Optional quote or motivation"

⑤ ACTION — BUTTON(S) AT BOTTOM

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Do & Don't

Do

- ✓ One focal orb per screen
- ✓ Generous padding — never cramped
- ✓ Serif for headings, sans for body
- ✓ Warm background showing through cards
- ✓ Animate with breathing cycles

Don't

- ✗ White backgrounds
- ✗ Hard shadows (only soft blur)
- ✗ Animations under .2s or over 5s
- ✗ Bold weight in body copy
- ✗ More than 2 buttons at once

- ✓ Quiet progress — dots, not bars
- ✓ Max one primary CTA per screen

- ✗ Dense information layouts
- ✗ Aggressive status colors (red, orange)



NORDIC WARM MINIMAL — STYLE GUIDE